

Restarting Cirrascale after losing the network contact

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

Feb 2026 new CTO (Alex Nataros)	Jan 2026 new Director of Engineering, Infrastructure	Sep 3 hiring a Director, Data Center Operations (Austin)	1 Chicago-area contact (IT Manager, 224)
STAGE Wave C prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Cirrascale (Wave C), 7 leads	LAST TOUCH Sep 29: call for James Cobb (deceased); no alternate given	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Brent Strange (Director of Engineering, Infrastructure)

Bottom line

On Sep 29 you learned that **James Cobb, Cirrascale's Network Operations Manager, has passed away**. That removed your main network contact, and the person who answered couldn't suggest anyone else. Cirrascale is a small AI cloud (about 30 people per ZoomInfo, parent BOXX Technologies) with **new technical leadership: CTO Alex Nataros (Feb 2026) and Brent Strange, Director of Engineering - Infrastructure (Jan 2026, ex-DigitalOcean AI/ML infrastructure)**. It's also hiring a Director of Data Center Operations in Austin. One clue: IT Manager **Ryan Graves has a 224 number (Chicago suburbs)**. The plan restarts gently with Strange, and asks Graves whether Cirrascale has anything in Chicago.

What Cirrascale is, in one analogy

Cirrascale is a boutique GPU rental shop next to the big-box stores (hyperscalers). Boutiques win on service and specific hardware, and they buy infrastructure carefully. A new infrastructure director is the shop's new buyer.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Alex Nataros appointed CTO (Feb 17, 2026)	ZoomInfo news	New technical leadership.
Brent Strange, Director of Engineering - Infrastructure (Jan 2026), ex-DigitalOcean AI/ML infrastructure	Apollo	Owns infrastructure engineering; likely the network decision-maker now.
Hiring Director, Data Center Operations in Austin (Sep 3)	ZoomInfo scoop	Data center footprint is growing (Austin).
Ryan Graves, IT Manager, 224 area code (Chicago suburbs)	Lemlist	Possible Chicago presence. Ask.

Check first	Mark James Cobb as deceased in HubSpot and remove him from every list so no automated message reaches his inbox again. Lemlist already unsubscribed him on Sep 29.
--------------------	--

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 11-28	Wave C, 3 emails	To Cobb, Nataros, Fritz, Graves	No replies
Sep 28-30	New leads	Peter Roth, Jeremy Ragland, Sai Addetla added; Addetla unsubscribed Sep 30	-
Sep 29	Phone	Called for James Cobb: deceased. No alternate contact offered.	Lost network contact
Sep 30	Catch-all campaign	Robert Murphy (Dir PM AI Infra) and DC/NOC technicians added to 'CTF ABM - Crusoe' list	List hygiene issue

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Brent Strange	Director of Engineering - Infrastructure since Jan 2026 (Apollo)	Idaho	New infrastructure owner.	Not contacted. brent.strange@cirrascale.com (verified)
Ryan Graves	IT Manager (HubSpot)	Chicago suburbs (224)	Possible Chicago tie.	Wave C, 2 emails
Peter Roth	Director, Data Center Strategy & Development (HubSpot)	NJ (201)	Site strategy owner.	Email 1 Sep 29
Matt Fish	Data Center Deployment Manager (Apollo)	Austin	Deploys sites.	Not contacted. matt.fish@cirrascale.com (verified)
Alex Nataros	CTO since Feb 2026 (HubSpot)	Dallas (214)	Executive. Hold.	Wave C, 2 emails

Not worth chasing for this goal

Data center and NOC technicians, and Sai Addetla (unsubscribed), are not buyers.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Ryan Graves IT Manager

Why them: Chicago-area number; can qualify in one line.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 5 | Subject: Cirrascale in Chicago?

Ryan, I noticed your number is a Chicago-area one. Does Cirrascale have an office or racks in the Chicago market? I own fiber there and want to know whether there's anything worth talking about before I bother your engineering team.

2. Brent Strange Director of Engineering - Infrastructure

Why them: New owner; quiet introduction.

Channel: Email Wed Oct 7 | Subject: Intro from a Chicago fiber owner

Brent, congratulations on the move from DigitalOcean. I'm with Crosstown Fiber in Chicago. I'd like to be a known option if Cirrascale ever needs diverse metro paths in the Midwest. No ask beyond that today; happy to send a map for your files.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Thu Oct 1	Mark James Cobb deceased in HubSpot; remove from lists.	Respectful and required.
Mon Oct 5	Email Ryan Graves.	-
Wed Oct 7	Email Brent Strange; add to HubSpot.	-
Fri Oct 9	Move Murphy and the technicians out of the 'CTF ABM - Crusoe' list.	List hygiene.
Week of Oct 19	Follow-up to Strange with the KMZ if Graves confirms Chicago presence.	-
Oct 30	Qualify in or out.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Know whether Cirrascale has a Chicago footprint	HubSpot note

Guardrails

- Never reference James Cobb in outreach.
- Credits used: 2 Apollo person enrichments; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot call log (Sep 29) and notes; Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Cirrascale (Wave C)'; ZoomInfo news (Feb 17, 2026) and scoops (Sep 3); Apollo people data (Oct 1, 2026).